Tales Abdo dos Santos

Lead UX & AI Designer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Lead UX & AI Designer with over 7 years of experience in product design and a background in development. I take products from conception to completion and do my best work on complex applications in specialized domains, where design and technical thinking meet. I coordinate design work across multinational, cross-functional teams, and I use an AI-native workflow with Claude and Figma agents to speed up research, requirements, UX/UI and prototyping, with every output shaped and validated by design judgment.

AREAS OF EXPERTISE

User-centered design | Process-centered design | UX writing | User Research | Design System | AI-native design | Information Architecture | Design Thinking | HCI | Problem-Solving | Stakeholder management | Project management | Agile methodologies | Front-end knowledge | Process improvement | Accessibility | Design Ops | Mentoring | Workshops | English (C1)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

AGILEENGINE **Brazil**

Lead UX & AI Designer *Nov 2024 – Present (Remote)*

- Lead and coordinate design for engineering requests (prototypes, presentations, communication digests and visual assets) as the main design contact, splitting the work across a team of 3 designers.
- Designed an AI-powered grant management platform that reduces human effort and errors: mapped user journeys and information architecture, ran user interviews, and designed from wireframes to high-fidelity prototypes.
- For almost a year, designed the experience of a highly secure cryptographic platform backed by NATO's DIANA program (client: m.sh).
- Built an AI-native design workflow with Claude and Figma agents for faster research and benchmarking, product requirements, user flows to high-fidelity UI, and working prototypes.
- Presented daily updates to the internal team and weekly updates to the client, keeping all stakeholders aligned.

RIVIAN **Brazil**

Senior Product Designer *Apr 2023 – Jul 2024 (Remote, contracted by Turing)*

- Designed for 8 high-density data applications for electrical engineers, delivering daily and bi-weekly updates to multiple stakeholders across the USA, India and Europe.
- Worked on design scope and user journey definition, assisting in the creation of 5 supply chain applications.
- Used user feedback for improvements, enhancing the experience for 3,000+ users.
- Managed my work using Jira and aligned with POs on prioritization and deliveries, consistently delivering daily assets for 8 applications and general cases.
- Aligned components and assets with other designers, guaranteeing the use of the Rivian Design System.
- Led the design transformation project on internal Rivian applications for the electrical engineering team, producing 200+ mockups distributed among 5 iterations.

IBM **São Paulo, Brazil**

Design Coordinator *Sep 2020 – Mar 2023 (Hybrid)*

- Coordinated the design team behind IBM's global hardware sales process transformation, covering 10+ internal and B2B applications used by 7,000+ employees and business partners, recognized with two Bronze Stevie Awards.
- Gathered requirements from all development teams, successfully coordinating the work capacity of 5 other designers across more than 10 applications.
- Prioritized tasks and managed backlog to ensure high quality and optimized deliveries, ensuring the design process was respected and wasn't a bottleneck in the product chain.
- Created diverse user research activities and assets to gather feedback and metrics on user satisfaction, using them to advocate for users in strategic decisions with clients and stakeholders.
- Mentored junior designers, with 1 of them later becoming part of the design team.

User Experience Designer *Sep 2019 – Aug 2020 (Hybrid)*

- Collaborated from discovery to execution on projects that generated results such as increased user adoption, a 20% reduction in sales cycle time, and a 30% reduction in support tickets.
- Redesigned IBM e-config on Cloud, a legacy hardware configurator used by 10,000+ IBMers and partners, raising its NPS from 6 to 8.5 in one month.
- Gathered and translated business requirements into high-quality deliverables such as user flows, wireframes, and Figma prototypes with more than 200 screens across more than 5 applications, using Scrum and Kanban.

- Initiated and facilitated discovery meetings and demonstrations for stakeholders, standardizing about 10 processes and helping automate 2 manual processes.
- Conducted extensive research and testing, gathering metrics and user insights to make design choices and moving applications' NPS from detractors to promoters.

Web Development / Design Intern *Apr 2018 – Sep 2019 (On-site)*

- Worked in front-end and back-end web development and as a UX designer within an agile team, supporting B2B applications for IBM hardware orders.
- Used Vue, React, Node.js, Sass, SQL, GitHub and Docker, working with blue/green deployment and TDD.

UNICAMP – PRÓ-REITORIA DE PESQUISA **Campinas, Brazil**

Undergraduate Student Researcher *Aug 2017 – Jul 2018*

- Researched applications and algorithms to aid in the comparison of conceptual maps.

EDUCATION

Pontifical Catholic University of Rio Grande do Sul (PUCRS) **Remote**
User Experience Design and Beyond (Postgraduate) *Nov 2024 – Oct 2025*

Campinas State University (UNICAMP) **São Paulo, Brazil**
Information Systems (Bachelor's degree) *Mar 2015 – Oct 2019*

São Paulo State Technical School (ETEC) **São Paulo, Brazil**
Computing (Technical Course) *Jan 2013 – Jun 2014*

CERTIFICATIONS & AWARDS

- Nielsen Norman Group UX Certification – Interaction Design Specialty (ID 1047059)
- Ellii English Placement Test – Advanced (C1), 93.3%
- Bronze Stevie® Award – Collaboration Solution (2021)
- Bronze Stevie® Award – Best Use of Customer Insight (2021)
- Call for Code IBM Brazil – Third Place
- IBM Recognized Speaker / Presenter

ADDITIONAL SKILLS & INTERESTS

Skills: Figma, FigJam, Miro, Framer, Jira, Claude, Figma AI agents, User flows, Personas, Journey maps, Low-fidelity wireframes, Executable prototypes, Pixel perfect, Responsiveness, Co-design, Presentations, High-density data, Data mapping, HTML, CSS, B2B, Complex applications, Specialized domains, Hardware, Electrical and Security industries, Analytical thinking, Leadership, Continuous learning, Growth mindset

Interests: Photography, Philosophy, Psychology, Dune, Severance, League of Legends, Baldur's Gate